World: Reflections on Marx and Marxism, New Haven, Yale University Press, p 81.

2. The classic texts are Buhkharin's *Imperialism and the World Economy*, originally published in 1915 with an introduction by Lenin, and Lenin's own *Imperialism: The Highest Stage of Capitalism* (1917). Both were drawing heavily on Hilferding's *Finance Capital*: *A Study in the Latest Phase of Capitalist Development* (1910), and influenced by Luxemburg's *The Accumulation of Capital* (1913).
3. The Marxist texts were influenced by the proto-Keynesian underconsumptionist arguments advanced in JA Hobson's famous book *Imperialism*: *A Study* (1902), which itself drew on writings by American business economists who were contending at the time that the domestic market was no longer able to sustain the enormous productive capacity of the new corporations or provide sufficient outlets for the capital they had accumulated. Such claims were, of course, soon to prove wildly wrong. It was not because profits could not be realised at home but to take advantage of additional opportunities that American capitalists invested abroad at the time. As Gabriel Kolko put it, in challenging William Appleman Williams's very influential revisionist history of the modern roots of American empire, which interpreted the Open Door policy in terms of the overall lack of profitable opportunities at home, it suggested a kind of 'transcendental false consciousness' whereby capital and the state 'failed to perceive where it was their main gains were to be made'. See Gabriel Kolko (1976) *Main Currents in Modern American History,* New York, Harper & Row, p 36. See also William Appleman Williams (1966) *The Contours of American History*, Chicago, Quadrangle. It is ironic in this light that mainstream non-Marxist theorists of US empire have belatedly endorsed Williams's approach. See Peter Cain (2002) *Hobson and Imperialism: Radicalism, New Liberalism and Finance 1887–1938*, Oxford, Oxford University Press, pp 111–115; Andrew J Bacevich (2002) *American Empire: The Realities and Consequences of U.S. Diplomacy*, Cambridge, MA, Harvard University Press; and Christopher Layne (2006) *The Peace of Illusions: American Grand Strategy from 1940 to the Present*, Ithaca, Cornell University Press.
4. Gareth Stedman Jones, 'The Specificity of US Imperialism', *New Left Review*, I/60, March–April 1970, p 60, n1. Giovanni Arrighi went so far as to say that what had 'once been the *pride* of Marxism – the theory of imperialism – had become a tower of Babel, in which not even Marxists knew any longer how to find their way.' *The Geometry of Imperialism*, London, NLB, 1978, p 17.
5. Especially telling in this respect, given Gunder Frank's original focus on Brazil in making the case for the 'development of underdevelopment' thesis, is the recent article by Virginia Fontes and Ana Garcia, Brazil's imperial capitalism, *Socialist Register 2014*.
6. This has been the case from Mandel's *Late Capitalism* (1974) to Arrighi's *Long Twentieth Century* (1994) to Harvey's *The New Imperialism* (2003) to Callincos's *Imperialism and Global Political Economy* (2009) to Radhika Desai's *Geopolitical Economy: After US Hegemony, Globalisation and Empire* (2013).
7. Of course, it remains conventionally thought that the Pentagon bears the greatest responsibility in the American state for containing the morbid symptoms that increasingly seem to come with globalisation. This view was perhaps most graphically expressed on the famous cover of the *New York Times Magazine* on 28 March 1999 featuring Thomas Friedman's 'Manifesto for a Fast World': superimposed over a mailed fist were the bold words: 'For globalisation to work, America can't be afraid to act like the almighty superpower that it is.' When the term 'empire' was openly embraced to characterise the American state at the time of the Bush administration's response to 9/11 (including by some of its advisors), the stress was placed, in Niall Ferguson's words, on the 'potential advantages of a self-conscious American imperialism' as against 'the grave perils of being an "empire in denial"', against the threat of 'non-state actors' like criminal organisations and terrorist cells. Niall Ferguson (2005) *Colossus: The Rise and Fall of the American Empire*, New York, Penguin, pp viii, xxvii.
8. G20 Toronto Summit communiqué, June 2010.
9. http://www.theguardian.com/business/2012/jul/05/quantitative-easing-explained.
10. Robert Rubin (2003) *In an Uncertain World*, New York, Random House, p 25.